DRUG AND TOXICOLOGY INFORMATION SERVICES

DATIS

Bulletin

APR 2025

Professor Dexter Tagwireyi

A TRUE SCHOLAR. A SERVANT LEADER. A NATIONAL TREASURE.

DRUG & TOXICOLOGY DATIS Information Service

Mr L Gadaga: Director | DATIS

Welcome to Datis Bulletin, the official publication of Drug and Toxicology Information Services (DATIS). We are dedicated to providing accurate, reliable, and up-to-date information on pharmaceuticals, toxicology, and healthcare advancements. Our mission is to empower healthcare professionals, researchers, and the public with the knowledge they need to make informed decisions and improve health outcomes.

At DATIS, we believe that sharing information is key to advancing healthcare and promoting safe and effective medication use. Through this bulletin, we aim to deliver practical insights, expert opinions, and the latest research developments. Whether it's guidance on drug safety, clinical best practices, or emerging trends in toxicology, our goal is to be your trusted source of information.

We also encourage collaboration and knowledge-sharing within our community. If you have valuable insights, articles, or experiences to share, we invite you to contribute to our bulletin. Together, we can foster a culture of continuous learning and innovation in healthcare.

Thank you for being part of our journey. We look forward to growing and learning together as we strive to make a positive impact in the world of healthcare.

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Designed by Shepard Mhlaba

Editor's Note

Dear Readers,

Welcome to the April edition of Datis Bulletin! This month, we are proud to honour a remarkable figure in the world of pharmacy and toxicology through our feature article: "Celebrating a National Treasure: The Outstanding Legacy of Professor Dexter Tagwireyi."

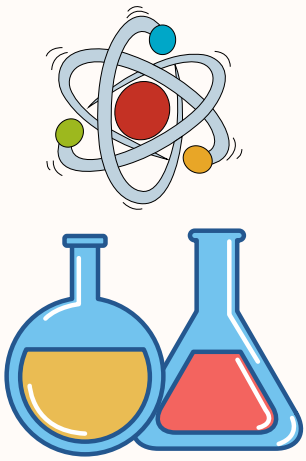
Professor Tagwireyi's contributions to clinical toxicology, research, and the development of pharmaceutical services in Zimbabwe and beyond have left an indelible mark. His legacy continues to inspire a new generation of pharmacists, scientists, and healthcare professionals committed to excellence and service.

As always, we invite you to be part of the conversation! You can advertise with us to connect with a dedicated audience in the pharmaceutical and healthcare space. If you have insights, research, or experiences to share, we welcome your contributions to keep the discussion rich and impactful. Send us an email: shepardmhlaba@gmail.com

Stay engaged, stay inspired, and enjoy this edition of Datis Bulletin!

Shepard Mhlaba

Editor-in-Chief



Celebrating a National Treasure: The Outstanding Legacy of Professor Dexter Tagwireyi

In the ever-evolving world of pharmaceutical sciences and toxicology, few names resonate with such reverence as that of Professor Dexter Tagwireyi—a pioneering academic, researcher, regulator, and thought leader whose contribution to Zimbabwe and the global scientific community is nothing short of extraordinary.

Professor Tagwireyi's journey began in Bulawayo, where he attended Milton High School before pursuing his Bachelor of Pharmacy (Honours) degree at the University of Zimbabwe, graduating in 1997. Driven by an insatiable curiosity and a passion for solving public health problems, he quickly rose through the academic ranks, earning a PhD in Applied Toxicology and later distinguishing himself further with a Master of Applied Science in Toxicology from RMIT University in Australia.

For more than two decades, Professor Tagwireyi has been at the heart of toxicological advancement in Zimbabwe. He currently serves as an Associate Professor in the Department of Pharmacy and Pharmaceutical Sciences at the University of Zimbabwe, where he has dedicated himself to teaching and mentoring the next generation of scientists. His influence extends beyond the classroom—he has supervised over 100 undergraduate research students, five Master of Philosophy (MPhil), and seven PhD graduates, many of whom have gone on to become influential researchers in their own right.

As the former Director of the Drug and Toxicology Information Service (DaTIS), Professor Tagwireyi laid the foundation for Zimbabwe's national poisons information infrastructure. He ran this unit for over a decade, providing pro bono expert consultations and producing scientific publications that have shaped national guidelines and global understanding of poisoning and envenomation in low-resource settings.

His extensive expertise has earned him numerous appointments to prestigious regulatory and advisory boards, including the Pharmacists Council of Zimbabwe, Health Professions Authority of Zimbabwe, and the Medicines Control Authority of Zimbabwe (MCAZ), where he sits on three expert committees. His work in toxicological risk assessment and health-based exposure limits (HBELs) has supported the pharmaceutical manufacturing industry across Southern Africa.

Prof. Tagwireyi's contributions are also global. He is a European Registered Toxicologist, a member of the UK Register of Toxicologists, and an active participant in international organisations such as the Society of Toxicology (SOT) and American College of Toxicology (ACT).

He has been a consultant for the World Health Organization (WHO), the United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA), and several pharmaceutical companies in Africa.

A prolific scholar, he has authored over 30 peer-reviewed journal articles and contributed to multiple books and international reports. Notably, his research on poisoning patterns in Zimbabwe has served as the basis for regional poison centre models and informed WHO policy recommendations.

Beyond academia and regulation, Professor Tagwireyi is an award-winning leader. He is a former Next Einstein Forum (NEF) Ambassador, a recipient of the African Union-TWAS Young Scientist Award, and an inaugural Fellow of the African Science Leadership Program. In 2015, he received the Pharmacists Council of Zimbabwe's highest honour for excellence in academia.

Despite these accolades, Professor Tagwireyi remains deeply committed to national service. His leadership on the editorial board of the DaTIS Bulletin, his active involvement in academic policy through ZIMCHE, and his mentorship of young toxicologists continue to enrich Zimbabwe's scientific landscape.

As we honour him in this special feature, we are reminded that Professor Tagwireyi's legacy is not only defined by awards or titles—but by the impact he has made on lives, knowledge, and systems.

A true scholar. A servant leader. A national treasure.

We at DaTIS, the pharmaceutical and toxicology communities, and the nation at large salute Professor Dexter Tagwireyi for his unwavering dedication to advancing science for public good.

MONGOOSE STRATEGY FOR PHARMACISTS: A DETAILED EXPLANATION

By Luckmore Bunu, MSc., B. Pharm Hons., MFIP

The mongoose, renowned for its agility, foresight, and adaptability, serves as a metaphor for pharmacists navigating complex challenges. Below is a comprehensive strategy structured around proactive engagement, rapid adaptation, and targeted problem-solving, with concrete examples:

1. Proactive Regulatory Engagement

Strategy: Anticipate and influence regulatory changes.

Actions:
- Establish a regulatory task force to monitor legislation (e.g., MCAZ updates, telehealth laws).
- Submit comments on proposed rules (e.g., advocating for pharmacist prescribing authority in emergencies).
- Host workshops to educate members on compliance (e.g., handling of Gallenical drugs).

Example: Preemptively draft telepharmacy guidelines in anticipation of telehealth expansion to ensure pharmacists are ready to implement services.

2. Technological Adaptation

Strategy: Integrate emerging technologies to enhance efficiency and patient care.

Actions:
- Partner with tech companies to pilot AI-driven inventory systems.
- Advocate for e-prescribing and blockchain for drug traceability.

Example: Collaborate with a startup to test drone delivery for rural pharmacies, improving access to medications.

3. Supply Chain Resilience

Strategy: Mitigate drug shortages through collaboration and innovation.

Actions:
- Create a regional stock-sharing network.
- Lobby for transparency in pharmaceutical manufacturing.

Example: Develop an app that alerts pharmacists to shortages in real time and provides alternative sourcing options.

4. Competitive Positioning

Strategy: Empower independent pharmacies to differentiate services.

Actions:
- Offer training in niche services (e.g., compounding, Medication Therapy Management).
- Promote partnerships with local clinics for chronic disease management.

Example: Launch a certification program for cannabis-based therapies.

5. Professional Development

Strategy: Foster continuous learning and leadership.

Actions:
- Develop CE courses on biotherapeutics and opioid stewardship.
- Offer leadership training for pharmacy owners.

Example: Host annual summits on personalized medicine, featuring experts in pharmacogenomics.

6. Advocacy and Lobbying

Strategy: Expand pharmacists' roles and reimbursement.

Actions:
- Campaign for legislative changes (e.g., allowing pharmacists to administer vaccines).
- Negotiate with payers for fair reimbursement models.

Example: Successfully lobby for recognition of pharmacists as primary care providers in underserved areas.

7. Crisis Management

Strategy: Prepare for emergencies with agile response plans.

Actions:
- Develop pandemic playbooks (e.g., PPE distribution, vaccine rollout).
- Train staff in crisis communication.

Example: During COVID-19, coordinate drive-through testing sites and secure federal funding for PPE.

8. Interprofessional Collaboration

Strategy: Integrate pharmacists into holistic care teams.

Actions:
- Form alliances with medical and nursing associations.
- Co-design care protocols (e.g., diabetes management).

Example: Partner with a hospital system to embed pharmacists in oncology teams, reducing medication errors.

9. Ethical Governance

Strategy: Balance legal mandates with patient-centered care.

Actions:
- Create ethical guidelines for opioid dispensing and refusal policies.
- Train pharmacists in cultural competency.

Example: Publish a decision tree for handling suspected opioid abuse while maintaining patient rapport.

10. Financial Sustainability

Strategy: Diversify revenue streams and payment models.

Actions:
- Promote subscription-based medication adherence programs.
- Advocate for value-based care contracts.

Example: Pilot a $30/month hypertension management service, including consultations and monitoring.

11. Public Relations

Strategy: Elevate pharmacists' public image as care providers.

Actions:
- Launch media campaigns highlighting vaccination roles.
- Engage influencers to share patient success stories.

Example: Feature pharmacists in TV segments during flu season, emphasizing vaccine safety.

12. Member Engagement

Strategy: Foster active participation and mentorship.

Actions:
- Conduct annual surveys to tailor services.
- Establish mentorship programs linking experienced pharmacists with new graduates.

Example: Create a "Young Pharmacists Council" to address generational challenges.

13. Data-Driven Decisions

Strategy: Leverage analytics for strategic insights.

Actions:
- Analyze prescription data to identify adherence trends.
- Use member feedback to refine advocacy priorities.

Example: Track reductions in hospital readmissions post-pharmacist intervention to demonstrate value.

14. Global Perspective

Strategy: Adopt international best practices.

Actions:
- Study models like the UK's Independent Prescribing Pharmacists.
- Adapt Canada's pharmacist-led smoking cessation programs.

Example: Implement a European-style "brown bag" medication review system to reduce polypharmacy in seniors.

15. Sustainability Initiatives

Strategy: Promote eco-friendly practices.

Actions:
- Advocate for biodegradable packaging.
- Launch drug take-back programs.

Example: Partner with manufacturers to recycle inhalers, reducing environmental impact.

Conclusion

The mongoose strategy emphasizes agility (rapid response to crises), foresight (anticipating regulatory and technological trends), and precision (targeted advocacy). By embodying these traits, pharmacists can transform challenges into opportunities, ensuring the profession thrives amid evolving healthcare landscapes. For instance, proactively lobbying for expanded roles positions pharmacists as indispensable, much like a mongoose neutralizing threats before they strike.

Luckmore Bunu, MSc., B. Pharm Hons., MFIP
X: @luckiebunu

Thank you

"As you step into this well-earned retirement, we celebrate your remarkable contributions"

Dear Mrs Munyoro,

On behalf of the entire DATIS family, we extend our heartfelt gratitude for your years of dedicated service and unwavering commitment. As you step into this well-earned retirement, we celebrate your remarkable contributions and the profound impact you have made on all of us.

Your time at DATIS has been marked by professionalism, integrity, and an exceptional sense of duty. As our Secretary, you played a pivotal role in ensuring the smooth running of our operations, always carrying out your responsibilities with diligence and grace. Your warm presence, patience, and unwavering support have left an indelible mark on colleagues and the institution as a whole.

We deeply appreciate the many ways in which you have gone above and beyond, ensuring that every task was completed with excellence and every challenge met with resilience. Your kindness, wisdom, and willingness to guide and mentor have touched the lives of many, and your legacy will continue to inspire us.

As you embark on this new chapter, we wish you abundant joy, good health, and fulfillment. May your retirement be filled with cherished moments, well-deserved relaxation, and the pursuit of all the things that bring you happiness.

Thank you, Mrs. Munyoro, for your exceptional service. You will always be a valued member of the DATIS family, and your contributions will be remembered with great admiration and appreciation.

With deepest gratitude and best wishes,

Shepard Mhlaba

THANK
YOU

DOMINO EFFECT

Why Choosing the Right Career Path is Essential

Introduction

Starting your career as a pharmacist is like setting up a row of dominos—each decision you make can set off a chain reaction, leading to exciting opportunities or unexpected setbacks. The choices you make early on can shape your entire professional journey. This guide will help you navigate these crucial decisions and build a career that is both fulfilling and rewarding.

Understanding the Domino Effect

Every career move—whether it's landing your first job, choosing a specialty, furthering your education, or expanding your professional network—has a ripple effect. A well-thought-out decision can open doors and lead to long-term success, while a poorly considered one might limit your options down the line.

Key Career Decisions That Shape Your Future:

1. *First Job Selection: The right first job can build strong foundations, helping you develop key skills and connections.*
2. *Specialization vs. General Practice: Deciding whether to focus on a niche or stay versatile can impact your career trajectory.*
3. *Continuous Learning: Further education, certifications, and CPD (Continuous Professional Development) can set you apart.*
4. *Work Environment Choice: The setting you choose—community pharmacy, hospital, industry, academia, or entrepreneurship—shapes your daily experiences and long-term prospects.*
5. *Networking & Mentorship: The people you connect with can introduce you to new opportunities and help you grow.*

Making Smart Career Moves

To create a positive domino effect in your career, consider these strategies:

1. Know Yourself

- What excites you about pharmacy? What are your strengths?
- Do you prefer structure or flexibility? Patient interaction or research?
- Define your long-term vision—leadership, innovation, specialization?

2. Explore Your Options

- Talk to experienced pharmacists about their journeys.
- Attend industry events, webinars, and CPD programs to learn about emerging opportunities.
- Don't be afraid to step outside your comfort zone and try new areas.

3. Find a Mentor

- A mentor can be your guiding light—helping you navigate tough decisions, avoid pitfalls, and seize the right opportunities.
- They offer valuable insights from their own experiences, help you expand your network, and boost your confidence.

4. Join Professional Organizations

- Being part of networks like FIP, Early Career Pharmacists Group (ECPG), and national pharmacy associations keeps you connected with the latest trends and career opportunities.
- Professional groups provide mentorship, career development resources, and chances to collaborate with peers globally.

5. Keep Learning & Growing

- Invest in additional training and certifications to stay competitive.
- Stay updated on industry trends like digital health, AI in pharmacy, and supply chain innovations.

6. Be Flexible & Resilient

- The pharmacy landscape is constantly evolving—embrace change and adapt.
- Learn from setbacks, stay curious, and always be open to new possibilities.

Your career path isn't set in stone, but every choice you make shapes the direction it takes. By being intentional with your decisions, continuously learning, surrounding yourself with the right people, and staying adaptable, you can set up a domino effect that leads to a thriving and fulfilling career.

Make every decision count—your future self will thank you!

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1. HANDBOOK OF EXPERIMENTAL PHARMACOLOGY (2007) | 2. CNS & NEUROLOGICAL DISORDERS DRUG TARGETS (2014) | 3. CNS & NEUROLOGICAL DISORDERS DRUG TARGETS (2014) | 4. BIOORGANIC & MEDICINAL CHEMISTRY (2015)

World Health Day

Healthy Beginnings, Hopeful Futures

World Health Day 2025, observed on April 7, focuses on the theme "Healthy Beginnings, Hopeful Futures," emphasizing maternal and newborn health. Here are five key facts about this year's observance:

1. Year-Long Campaign:

The World Health Organization (WHO) has initiated a year-long campaign starting on World Health Day 2025 to enhance maternal and newborn health globally.

2. Goals of the Campaign:

The campaign aims to end preventable maternal and newborn deaths and prioritize the long-term health and well-being of women.

3. Global Events:

WHO is organizing global events to raise awareness and share information about improving survival rates and health outcomes for mothers and babies.

4. Public Participation Encouraged:

Individuals are encouraged to participate by spreading awareness using hashtags like #HopefulFutures and #HealthForAll, attending events, donating, and sharing personal experiences related to maternal and newborn health.

5. Alignment with Sustainable Development Goals:

The campaign supports WHO's aim of reducing the global maternal mortality rate to less than 70 per 100,000 live births by 2030, in line with the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goal 3.

These initiatives underscore the global commitment to improving health outcomes for mothers and newborns, laying the foundation for healthier families and communities worldwide.

EXPLORING THE LINK BETWEEN MINDSET AND PSYCHOLOGICAL WELLBEING AMONG PHARMACY STUDENTS IN ZIMBABWE

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Abstract

Introduction

Mindset may influence pharmacy students' psychological wellbeing. However, little is known about the relationship between mindset and psychological wellbeing among pharmacy students. This study aimed to explore the association between mindset and psychological wellbeing in pharmacy students in Zimbabwe.

Method

Fourth-year pharmacy students from the University of Zimbabwe and Harare Institute of Technology were invited to participate via their class WhatsApp groups. An online survey, linked through a cover letter, was distributed to measure students' mindsets, psychological wellbeing, and demographic characteristics. Descriptive and inferential statistics were used to assess the relationships among psychological wellbeing, mindset, and demographic factors.

Results

Of the 124 fourth-year pharmacy students, 85 completed the survey (response rate: 68.5 %). Most students demonstrated a growth mindset (n = 43; 56.6 %), while 33 (43.4 %) had a fixed mindset. Students with a strong growth mindset had a higher mean psychological wellbeing score (mean = 57.5; SD = 5.2) compared to those with a strong fixed mindset (mean = 52.4; SD = 4.4; p = 0.048). No associations were found between mindset or psychological wellbeing and age, gender, spirituality, marital status, or institution attended.

Conclusion

The majority of students exhibited a growth mindset, which was associated with better psychological wellbeing. Demographic and personal characteristics were not related to students' psychological wellbeing or mindsets. Pharmacy schools and educators should actively promote a growth mindset to enhance students' psychological wellbeing.

https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S1877129725000218?via%3Dihub

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REF: B/279/35/04/2025

CIRCULAR 04 of 2025

Date: 19th March 2025

To: All MCAZ Licence and Permit Holders and prospective Licence and Permit Holders

RE: DECLARATION REQUIREMENT FOR DIRECTORS AS A CONDITION OF LICENSURE

The Medicines Control Authority of Zimbabwe (MCAZ) wishes to advise its stakeholders that there is a new requirement for directors of pharmaceutical companies to disclose their contravention of the Medicines and Allied Substances Control Act (*Chapter 15:03*) ('the Act") and the regulations thereof or the Dangerous Drugs Act (*Chapter 15:02*) and the regulations thereof as a condition of licensure. This new requirement is part of the efforts by the Authority to ensure compliance with relevant laws and regulations governing the pharmaceutical industry in Zimbabwe.

THE LEGAL POSITION

Section 72 of the Act provides as follows:

72 Act or omission by manager, agent or employee

(1) Whenever any manager, agent or employee of any person, hereinafter called the employer, does or omits to do any act which it would be an offence under this Act for the employer to do or omit to do, then, unless it is proved that—

(a) in doing or omitting to do that act the manager, agent or employee was acting without the connivance or the permission of the employer; and

(b) all reasonable steps were taken by the employer to prevent any act or omission of the kind in question; and

(c) it was not under any condition or in any circumstances within the scope of the authority or in the course of the employment of the manager, agent or employee to do or to omit to do acts, whether lawful or unlawful, of the character of the act or omission charged;

the employer shall be presumed himself to have done or omitted to do that act and shall be liable to be convicted and sentenced in respect thereof.

(2) The fact that the employer issued instructions forbidding any act or omission of the kind in question shall not, of itself, be accepted as sufficient proof that he took all reasonable steps to prevent the act or omission.

(3) Whenever any manager, agent or employee of any such employer does or omits to do an act which it would be an offence under this Act for the employer to do or omit to do, he shall be liable to be convicted and sentenced in respect thereof as if he were the employer.

(4) Any such manager, agent or employee may be so convicted and sentenced in addition to the employer.

Sub-section (1) attaches criminal liability to a person/employer for the actions or omissions of their manager, agent or employee which would constitute an offence under the Act. There are exceptions provided in paragraphs (a) – (c) which include cases where there was no connivance or permission by the employer, where the employer took reasonable steps to prevent the act or omission and when it was not within the scope of employment of the manager, agent or employee to do or omit to do those acts.

Sub-section (2) provides that the fact that an employer issued instructions prohibiting that act or omission shall not be sufficient proof that reasonable steps were taken to prevent the act or omission.

Sub-section (3) attaches criminal liability to a manager, agent or employee who does or omits to do an act which would be an offence under the Act for the employer to do or omit to do.

Sub-section (4) provides that the manager, agent or employee may be convicted and sentenced together with the employer.

"Person" or "employer" referred to in sub-section (1) refers to pharmaceutical companies. Pharmaceutical companies are juristic persons within the contemplation of Section 72 of the Act in which case the "agent" referred to are the directors.

The legal definition of an agent is 'a person authorised to act on behalf of another person or entity, known as the principal, and has the power to bind the principal to contracts, agreements or other obligations'. Directors are agents of the companies for which they are directors.

Section 72 places joint liability on both the employer/person and employees/managers/agents/ for the offences of either party.

DECLARATION REQUIREMENT

To give effect to Section 72 of the Act, with effect from the 24th of March 2025, all directors of pharmaceutical companies applying for licensure or renewal of licensure must fill in a declaration form stating whether/that:

1. They have not contravened the Medicines and Allied Substances Control Act (Chapter 15:03) and the regulations thereof or the Dangerous Drugs Act (Chapter 15:02) and the regulations thereof in their capacity as director of a pharmaceutical company within the past three years.
2. The pharmaceutical company for which they are or were director has not contravened the Medicines and Allied Substances Control Act (Chapter 15:03) and the regulations thereof or the Dangerous Drugs Act (Chapter 15:02) and the regulations thereof.
3. They understand that providing false information may result in the denial or revocation of their licence/permit.
4. They acknowledge that, as a condition of licensure, they are required to maintain compliance with all relevant laws and regulations governing the pharmaceutical industry in Zimbabwe.
5. They understand that if, as director of a pharmaceutical company or the pharmaceutical company thereof contravene the Medicines and Allied Substances Control Act (Chapter 15:03) and the regulations thereof or the Dangerous Drugs Act (Chapter 15:02) and the Regulations thereof, the Authority reserves the right to call the director for a hearing in

his/her personal capacity and deal with the matter as it sees fit.

The declaration form can be accessed from the MCAZ website www.mcaz.co.zw

MEDICINES CONTROL AUTHORITY OF ZIMBABWE

.....

Richard T. Rukwata (Mr)
DIRECTOR-GENERAL

Cc: Pharmacists Council of Zimbabwe **(PCZ)**
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REF: B/279/35/06/2025

CIRCULAR 6 of 2025

Date: 21st March 2025

To: APPLICANTS, MANUFACTURERS, WHOLESALERS, PREMISES LICENCE HOLDERS, AND RETAIL OUTLETS

RE: CLARIFICATION ON THE SALE AND DISTRIBUTION OF UNAPPROVED PHARMACOPOEIAL AND GALENICAL PREPARATIONS

This circular is a follow up to Circular 28 of 2024 issued on the 11th December 2024. The Medicines Control Authority of Zimbabwe (MCAZ), hereinafter referred to as "*The Authority*," seeks to clarify its position on the sale and distribution of Pharmacopoeial and Galenical preparations. With respect to MCAZ Circular 28 of 2024, the following definitions shall be applicable:

Galenical preparations: Medicines prepared according to the formulae of Galen. The term now denotes standard preparations containing one or several organic ingredients, as contrasted with pure chemical substances.

Pharmacopoeial preparations: Preparations made according to official pharmacopeial directions. Official pharmacopoeias include British Pharmacopoiea (B.P.) and United States Pharmacopoiea (USP).

Manufacture: Includes compounding, processing, or packing for sale but excludes the compounding of a medicine by a medical practitioner, dental practitioner, veterinary surgeon, or pharmacist if that medicine:
(a) has not been advertised for sale in Zimbabwe; and
(b) does not contain any component whose sale is prohibited by the Medicines and Allied Substances Control Act; and
(c) is supplied for the treatment of a particular person or animal.

The Authority has received several inquiries regarding Circular 28 of 2024 and provides the following clarifications:

1. **Pharmacopoeia preparations** are registrable, the sale of unregistered pharmacopeial preparations is illegal.
2. **Orally administered galenical preparations** such as liquid paraffin, castor oil, clove oil, and cod liver oil must be registered and manufactured in a cGMP-compliant manufacturing facility.
3. **Multipurpose preparations**: While the Authority recognises that some galenical preparations can also be used as foodstuffs and cosmetics, those intended for medicinal purposes must be manufactured by **licensed pharmaceutical manufacturers** and

referenced to the relevant pharmacopoeia, as the standards for food grade and pharmaceutical grade differ. Anyone intending to sell galenical formulations for cosmetic use, must clearly state on the label that the product is not a medicine but a cosmetic.

For example, coconut oil, has antimicrobial properties and is used to promote wound healing as a medicine but can also be used as a cosmetic conditioner for hair. The label for coconut oil intended to be used as a cosmetic should explicitly state that the product is not a medicine but a cosmetic. Conversely coconut oil intended to be used as a medicine must be manufactured by licensed pharmaceutical manufacturers and referenced to the relevant pharmacopoeia.

Healthcare professionals should refrain from selling non-medicinal preparations for medicinal purposes, as the quality of these preparations is currently not regulated by the Authority.

4. The sale of preparations that do not clearly state their intended use on the label is prohibited.
5. Pharmacists are still permitted to compound galenical preparations; however, they must maintain pristine records and should not sell their products to other practitioners but compound for direct sale to their customers only.

Requirements for registration of pharmacopeial and galenicals preparations:

Module 1

1. Duly completed CM1 form
2. Two product samples
3. Product labels (including all the required details as per S.I. 97 of 2015)

Quality information

4. Source of API (including certificates of analysis)
5. Description of the manufacturing process
6. Manufacturer (including GMP status)
7. Finished product specifications (including certificates of analysis)
8. Packaging material specifications (including a specific identification test)
9. Stability summary

The Authority upholds its mandate to ensure access to safe, effective, and high-quality medical products and allied substances for the protection of public and animal health.
For further information, please contact MCAZ at mcaz@mcaz.co.zw.

Yours faithfully
MEDICINES CONTROL AUTHORITY OF ZIMBABWE

.....
R.T. Rukwata (Mr.)
DIRECTOR-GENERAL

MCAZ Medicines Control Authority of Zimbabwe

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P.O. Box 10559
Harare
Zimbabwe

Ref: B/279/10/2025

CIRCULAR 10 OF 2025

Date: 10th April 2025

To: ALL LICENSED PHARMACEUTICAL WHOLESALERS, PHARMACIES, PUBLIC AND PRIVATE CLINICS AND HOSPITALS

RE: CLASS II RECALL UP TO RETAIL LEVEL OF TORRENT CAPTOPRIL 25MG TABLETS, REG. NO.: 2000/12.3.5/3685, BATCH: B520K001, MANUFACTURED BY TORRENT PHARMACEUTICALS LTD, INDRAD PLANT, NEAR INDRAD VILLAGE, TALUKA KADI, DISTRICT MEHSANA, GUJARAT, INDIA

Torrent Pharmaceuticals Ltd is recalling units of Torrent Captopril 25mg Tablets manufactured by Torrent Pharmaceuticals Ltd, India. The reported batch of Captopril 25mg tablets is being recalled because an out of specification (OOS) in the limit of Captopril disulfide (OOS No: OOS/BST/25/004). Non-compliance with specifications of product quality may result in loss of function and harm to the patient.

The Authority would like to draw attention of all licensed wholesalers, pharmacies, public and private clinics and hospitals that they should quarantine any of the affected units of the reported product and cooperate with Torrent Pharmaceuticals Ltd and local distributors of the product in Zimbabwe during the recall process. The general public who might have purchased same reported batch are advised to return the product to the pharmacy where they obtained the medicine.

Yours faithfully,

MEDICINES CONTROL AUTHORITY OF ZIMBABWE

.....
Richard T. Rukwata (Mr.)
For: **DIRECTOR-GENERAL**
/mm

🩺 DaTIS Enquiries – Your Lifeline in Critical Moments!

At the Drug and Toxicology Information Service (DaTIS), we understand how urgent and complex clinical decisions can be. That's why we provide fast, reliable support for healthcare professionals when it matters most.

Pharmacists, doctors, and all health professionals — DaTIS is here to assist you with expert advice on poisoning, drug information, snake bites, and scorpion stings.
📄 Fill out the attached enquiry google form or
📞 Call our office directly — because every second counts.

Our mandate is clear: to save lives.
Let DaTIS be your trusted partner in clinical emergencies.

DATIS TEAM

DIRECTOR

Louis Gadaga is the Chairperson of the Department of Pharmacy and Pharmaceutical Sciences at University of Zimbabwe. He is a lecturer in the Pharmaceutics and Clinical Pharmacy section. He is the Director of the Drug and Toxicology Information Service and he is a member of various societies. His research interest is in neuropharmacology, toxicity testing, natural products, nanotoxicology and nanomedicine, formulation and characterisation of novel oral delivery systems for the effective delivery of traditional medicines. He has also supervised over 40 undergraduate honours research students. He is currently embarking on his PhD. He has over 10 publications.

HEAD OF OPERATIONS AND COMPLIANCE

Shepard Nqobile Mhlaba serves as the Global Lead for Early Career Training Strategy at the International Pharmaceutical Federation (FIP), where he plays a pivotal role in shaping pharmacy education and workforce development. He is also a journal reviewer for the FIP Pharmacy Education Journal (PEJ), contributing to the advancement of pharmaceutical research.

In addition, Shepard is the Assistant Director at the Drug and Toxicology Information Services (DATIS), where he supports drug information dissemination and toxicology expertise. His contributions to pharmacy research and innovation have been recognized through the FIP Health and Medicines Information Section (HaMIS) Travel Grant (2019) and the FIP Young Pharmacists Group (YPG) Grant for Professional Innovation (2019), underscoring his commitment to advancing the profession.

HEAD OF RESEARCH AND POLICY

Nicholas Muparadzi is currently working as a Data Support Coordinator at the International Pharmaceutical Federation (FIP) in the Global Pharmaceutical Observatory (GPO) team. Nicholas is also working as a pharmacist at the Drug and Toxicology Information Services (DaTIS), located at the Department of Pharmacy, University of Zimbabwe. Previously, Nicholas has served in the FIP ECPG Steering Committee as the Chairperson of Public Relations.

Nicholas also worked in the HaMIS, Member Communications Committee (MemCo), and was a recipient of the 2024 HaMIS congress travel grant. Nicholas is the Mashonaland/Manicaland Branch Chairperson at the Pharmaceutical Society of Zimbabwe (PSZ) and immediate past chairman of the Pharmacists Against Drug Abuse (PADA).

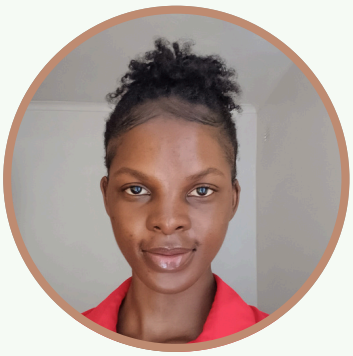
HEAD OF TRAINING AND DEVELOPMENT

Tawanashe Karemba is a registered pharmacist with over 5 years experience in Community Pharmacy. He is an enthusiastic academic currently holding a Master's in Clinical Pharmacology (UZ) as well as a Master's in Public Health (University of Suffolk).

Tawanashe currently serves as a lecturer at the University of Zimbabwe in the Department of Pharmacy and Pharmaceutical Sciences, where he is passionate about teaching and research. His key areas of interest include Clinical Pharmacy, Clinical Toxicology, and Public Health. He is also working as a pharmacist at Drug and Toxicology Information Services (DaTIS).

DATIS PRE-REGISTERED PHARMACISTS

REVIEWERS



Vongai Chirove is a pre-registration pharmacist who obtained a BPharm from Rhodes University. Her main interests are medicinal chemistry and pharmaceutics. The combination of creativity, innovation, and science fuel her passion for pharmacy and she aspires to utilize these in making a significant contribution to improving the quality of healthcare.

Kudzai Daisy Kahwenga is a pre-registration pharmacist doing her training at DaTIS. She holds an MPharm in Clinical Pharmacy from Sefako Makgatho Health Sciences University and has worked across South Africa and Zimbabwe. A passionate mental health advocate, she has experience as a lecturer, in hospital, and community pharmacy, and is dedicated to improving care in underserved communities through research, advocacy, and expanding access to healthcare and education. She is also actively involved in international organisations such as the International Pharmaceutical Students' Federation, where she aims to promote health equity and professional development for pharmacy students and young pharmacists.

Rukudzokunashe is a wellness pharmacist with a strong interest in functional medicine and integrative health. She blends pharmaceutical expertise with a holistic approach to address root causes of health issues. Passionate about personalized care, Ruku empowers individuals to achieve lasting wellness through lifestyle interventions, targeted nutrition, and science-based natural therapies.

Hephzibar Delight Chakanetsa is a pharmacist and Rhodes University graduate with a strong interest in clinical pharmacy. She is passionate about advancing patient care.Outside of work, she enjoys reading, exploring nature, and learning about new healthcare innovations and practices.

Faith Notisi, a 24-year-old BPharm graduate from Nelson Mandela University, is a dedicated and passionate young woman in the pharmaceutical field. With a strong commitment to healthcare and community well-being, she aspires to make a meaningful impact through her knowledge, compassion, and continuous professional growth in the pharmacy profession.

DATIS Bulletin

04 EDITION
2025
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